

Guinea-Bissau

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** September 24, 1973 **Usage:** National and Civil



Africa



Guinea-Bissau is so-called to distinguish it from the former French Guinea. Formerly a territory of Portugal, it achieved self-government in 1973.

Like the former flag of Cape Verde, the flag is based on that of the *Partido Africano para a Independência da Guiné e Cabo Verde* (PAIGC), still the dominant party in Guinea-Bissau.

THE GHANAIAIN INFLUENCE

The party flag was derived from that of Ghana, which first used the

pan-African combination of red, yellow, green, and black in 1957. In the Ghanaian view, the black star stands for the unity of Africa. The colors are now said to stand for the blood shed for independence, hope, and the sun, as the source of life.

The coat of arms is the PAIGC badge, a black star and a scallop shell.

ARMS OF GUINEA-BISSAU

